8. In a seminar held in 1971, the issue of whether the designation of the North Black Polished Ware should be changed was discussed. This is because such pottery was found in western India and the Deccan, and we now know that it is found in the peninsular South as well. Moreover, there are shades other than black, ranging from golden to brown, and also because the term ‘polished’ can be misleading since the surface lustre was not produced through polishing. Archaeologists stayed with the existing designation because the material is found in much larger quantity in the North than elsewhere. Additionally, more than 80 per cent of the specimens of this pottery are black. As for the term ‘polished’, it accurately described what the pottery surface looked like and thus was taken to be a reference to the resultant effect that was created. See Sinha (1971–2): 29–33.

9. For an overview of the archaeology of Pataliputra, Sinha (2000): 88–134, and Kumar (1987). Kumar has summarized the issue of the dating of the NBP phase on the basis of the excavations of B.P. Sinha and L.A. Narain (p. 220): ‘The NBP level in Pataliputra as based upon the excavations at Sadargali and Mahavirghata has been ascribed to a period ranging from 6th century BC to 2nd century AD. The NBP sherds continued right from the earliest occupation levels but in its upper level the NBP was found associated with coins of the lanky bull type of Kausambi prevalent before *circa* 100 BC. The coins were collected in fairly good number but immediately after this level the NBP sherds disappear completely, hence, the upper limit of this ware has been placed somewhere towards the end of 150 BC or later. The lower limit of the NBP ware was mainly fixed on the basis of the fragments of couchant bull and other polished stone pieces of the Mauryan period which came from the mid level of Period I. Right below the level the 5’ deposit must have taken 2 or 3 centuries to set at the site. Punch-marked and cast coins generally belonging to the period between 5th century BC to 2nd century BC were also found in association with the NBP sherds. Thus the chronology of the NBP at Pataliputra has been determined taking into account the Mauryan sculptural fragments bearing typical Mauryan polish from the mid-level and the 5’ deposit yielding NBP sherds continuing right below this level upto the natural soil. This indicated an earlier time span of the NBP types at Pataliputra.’ For the prediction of the Buddha, ‘Maha Parinibbana Suttanta’, *Digha Nikaya* ii.86, in Rhys Davids (1910): vol. 2, 92.

10. ‘Maha Parinibbana Suttanta’, *Digha Nikaya* ii.86, in Rhys Davids (1910): vol. 2, 92.

11. Ghosh (1989): vol. 2, 362–5.